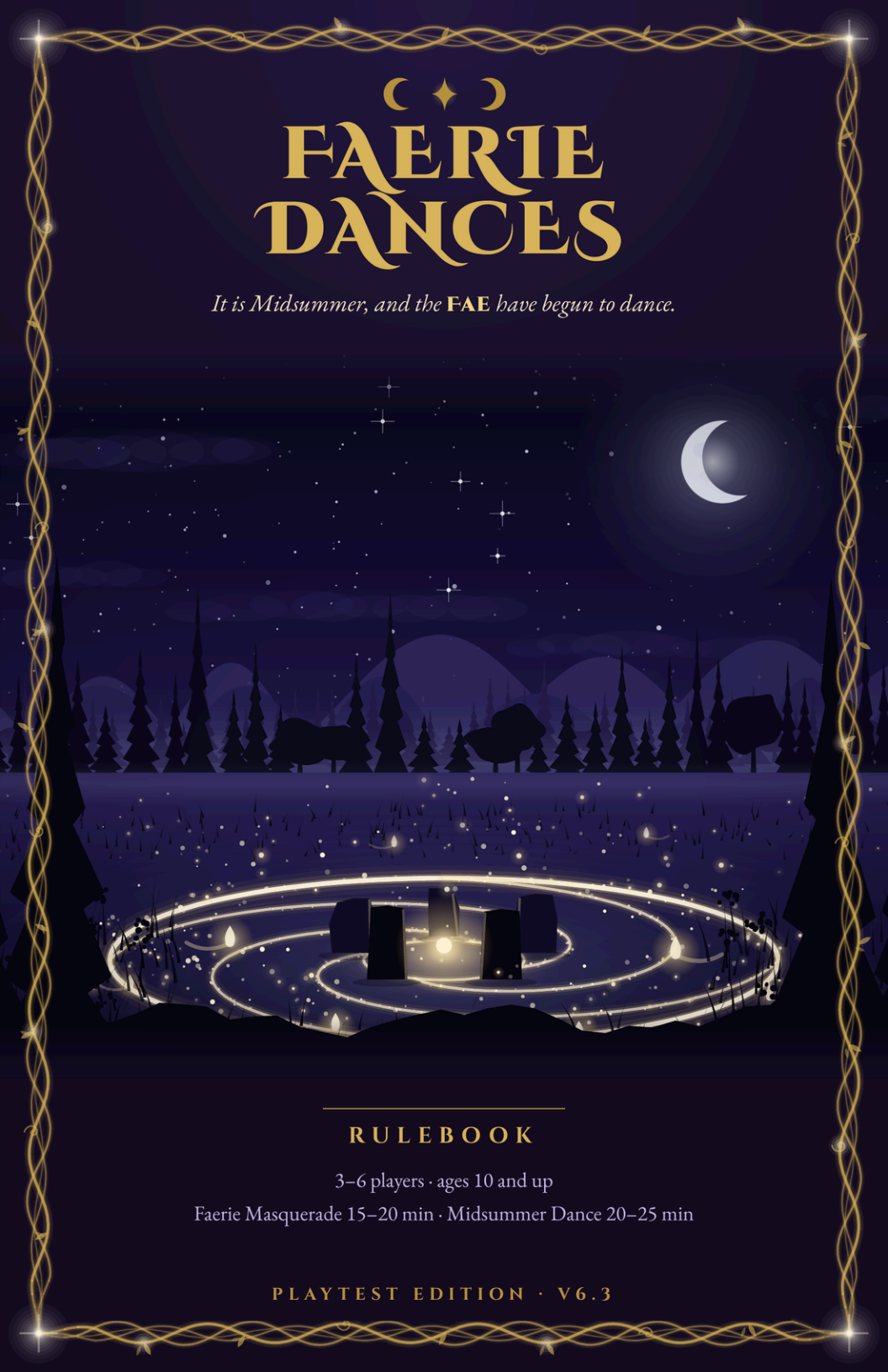




FAERIE DANCES

*It is Midsummer, and the **FAE** have begun to dance.*

RULEBOOK

3–6 players · ages 10 and up

Faerie Masquerade 15–20 min · Midsummer Dance 20–25 min

PLAYTEST EDITION · V6.3

THE TALE

On Midsummer night the four great Courts of Mountain, Meadow, Forest, and River send their delegates to dance before the High Fae. Each dancer splits into two shimmering Glamours and dances the ancient paths: the Faerie Ring, the Faerie Fort, the Faerie Mound, and the flickering Faerie Bridge. The High Fae step forth in terrible majesty and proclaim their challenge:

“To the noble Fae whose Radiance burns brightest in the Court in which the Wisps have thronged, to that Fae is granted a True Name.”

Using ancient runes the Glamours begin their dances. As they twist and twirl, luminous Will-o'-the-Wisps gather in the Courts, and the High Fae grant favors for unveiling them. But no Fae can see their own Radiance, and so the Glamours shift, deceive, and wield Faerie Magik to outshine one another.

Can you shine brightest, earning the right to Call for your True Name from the High Fae?

OVERVIEW

OBJECTIVE

Have the highest Radiance in the Court where a player Calls for their True Name.

Each player has a secret **Court card** (their allegiance, bearing the **High Fae patron** who supports them) and a **Radiance card**, a number visible to every other player but not to its owner. Players move Glamours along the dances. Completing a dance places a Wisp and grants a favor. At the start of any of your turns, you may **declare your patron**, revealing your Court to gain the patron's gift (p. 4).

When a Court holds **5 or more Wisps**, a player completing a dance may **Call for their True Name** in that Court. Placing a **7th Wisp** in a Court triggers a Call automatically. If a Call resolves, all players reveal their Court and Radiance cards: the **highest Radiance** player who belongs to the Court where the Call happened wins the game.

THE TWO GAMES

- **Faerie Masquerade** (base game): three dances. No rune powers, no stone actions.
- **Midsummer Dance** (full game): adds the Faerie Bridge, Conjured Stones, and rune powers.

Rules marked ♦ apply to the Midsummer Dance only. Play the Masquerade first.

THE PIECES



BOARD · 1

Four dances, four Courts.



COURT CARDS · 16

In every Court, one card for each High Fae: Queen, King, Prince, Princess. Your secret allegiance, and your patron.



RADIANCE CARDS · 9

Numbered 1–9, all unique. Yours faces away from you.



CARD STANDS · 6

One per player; holds your Radiance card facing away.



WISPS · 28

Flame meeples. Court markers.



FAERIE MAGIK · 20

Cold Iron ×4; all other cards ×2.



STONES · 25

Two-sided: plain and Conjured. 18 for the Faerie Ring, Fort & Mound; 7 for the Bridge. ♦



GLAMOURS · 12

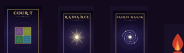
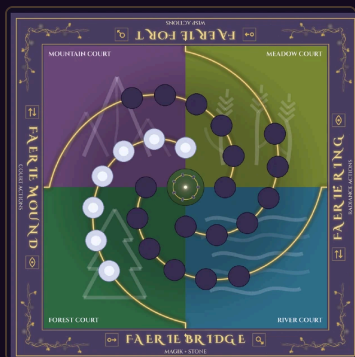
Faerie tokens, 2 per player.



FAE RUNES · 36

Runes 1–6, one hand per player.

SETUP



The three decks and the Wisps wait beside the board.

- Shuffle the Court, Radiance, and Faerie Magik decks separately. Place them face down beside the board, with the Wisps.
- Each player takes 1 Court card (look at it, noting your Court allegiance and patron; keep it face down), 1 Radiance card placed facing away in a card stand without looking at it, the 6 Fae Runes, 1 Faerie Magik card, and 2 Glamours kept in a reserve.
- Place 6 stones, plain side up, on the spaces of the Faerie Ring, the Faerie Fort, and the Faerie Mound.
- **Masquerade:** the Faerie Bridge is not used. ♦ **Midsummer:** place 7 stones on the Faerie Bridge, Conjured side up.
- Choose a start player at random. Play proceeds clockwise.

YOUR TURN

PLAY A RUNE

Place 1 rune from your hand face up in front of you, then move your Glamours a total number of steps up to its value. When you have played all 6, take them back into your hand at the end of that turn.



Your hand: six Fae Runes.

Recover: instead of playing a rune you may skip your turn and take all your spent runes back at once.

MOVEMENT

- Divide the steps between your two Glamours in any order.
- A Glamour moves 1 stone per step, always inward, never outward.
- Entering play from your reserve costs 1 step, onto any dance's **outermost** stone.
- Stones are never blocked; Glamours may share one.
- Unspent steps are lost.



One step inward.

COMPLETING A DANCE

When a Glamour ends a step on a dance's **innermost** stone, resolve in this order:

- Place 1 Wisp in any single Court.
- Draw 1 Faerie Magik card. ♦ **Midsummer: skip this step.**
- Choose one: take **one** of that dance's favors (p. 6), or Call for Your True Name (p. 5).



The innermost stone: the dance is complete.

Return the Glamour to your reserve: it cannot enter play again this turn, and so completes at most one dance per turn. Remaining steps pass to your other Glamour; if both have danced, they are lost.

THE HIGH FAE

As the very first thing on your turn, before any rune, Faerie Magik, or other action, you may turn your Court card **face up**. Your allegiance and patron are now public, and your patron's gift is yours for as long as the card lies face up before you. A declared card is never turned face down while you hold it; you cannot declare at any other moment. If a declared Court card is swapped, it remains declared for its new player. If it is discarded, the new Court card is kept face down.

THE QUEEN · Add +2 to your Radiance at the Call, and you break any ties.

THE KING · Each turn, when you dance a Fae Rune (or dance by Midsummer Reel), you gain 1 additional step.

THE PRINCE · When you declare, place 1 Wisp in any Court. While declared, no Wisp can be lured out of your Court.

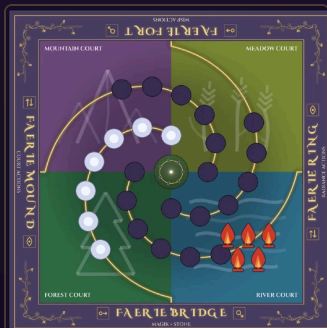
THE PRINCESS · While declared, you also belong to both adjacent Courts, printed on the card: you may win a Call in any of your three Courts, and you count as belonging to each.

HOW TO WIN

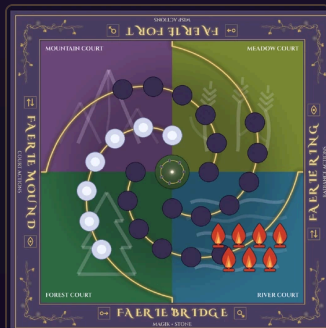
CALL FOR YOUR TRUE NAME

As the game progresses, more Wisps gather in the Courts. When a player completes a dance and places the 5th Wisp in a Court, they may **Call** for their True Name rather than taking that dance's favor. If the Call holds, everyone reveals their Court and Radiance cards.

The player with the highest Radiance, who belongs to the Court where the Call happened, wins!



5 or more Wisps gather in a Court: a player completing a dance may Call there, instead of taking a favor.



A 7th Wisp enters a Court: a Call happens there immediately, no matter who placed it.

Rivals may interrupt a Call with Faerie Magik (p. 6). If the Court falls below the number that triggered it (5, or all 7), the Call fails: nothing is revealed, the favor is spent, and play continues. The Call is won by the highest Radiance belonging to the called Court, whether or not they made the Call. A Patron's power only matters if it is already declared prior to the Call; if a Patron is undeclared at the Call, disregard the Patron's power.

EXAMPLE · A CALL AT 5 WISPS

Alex completes the Faerie Mound and places her Wisp in the River Court, bringing it to 5. Instead of taking a favor, she Calls there. Blake answers with **Snuff Out** and removes a River Wisp. The River now holds 4, so the Call fails: nothing is revealed, Alex's favor is spent, and play continues.

EXAMPLE · A CALL AT 7 WISPS

Later, Blake completes a dance and places a 7th Wisp in the Meadow Court, so a Call happens there at once, with Blake as the caller. Alex plays **Wisp-Lure** to draw one away, but Blake answers with **Cold Iron** and cancels it. The Meadow still holds 7, so everyone reveals. Alex belongs to the Meadow with Radiance 8, the highest there. Alex wins, even though Blake made the Call.

EXAMPLE · THE QUEEN'S TIE

A Call resolves in the Forest. Cass belongs there with Radiance 7. Dara belongs there too, holds Radiance 5, and declared the **Queen of the Forest** two turns ago: her 5 counts as 7, and the Queen takes ties. Dara wins.

THE FAVORS

Completing a dance grants one favor from that dance, or a Call in its place.



FAERIE RING · *Radiance favors*

- Swap Radiance cards with a rival. Both place the received card facing away.
- Peek at your own Radiance, then return it facing away.



FAERIE FORT · *Wisp favors*

- Lure 1 Wisp from one Court to another.
- Snuff two Wisps total from any Court(s). If only 1 Wisp is on the board, remove 1.



FAERIE MOUND · *Court favors*

- Swap Courts with a rival. Each looks at their new card in secret (*a face-up card arrives declared*).
- Peek at one rival's Court card, learning their Court *and* their patron.



◆ FAERIE BRIDGE

- Draw 1 Faerie Magik card, then you must choose one:
- Move 1 Conjured Stone
 - Flip 1 stone

FAERIE MAGIK

Kept hidden in hand. A card may be played only at its listed time. No hand limit.



MIDSUMMER REEL ×2 · Move as if you had played a rune of your choice (1–6), without spending one. ◆ The chosen rune's power applies. *Play on your turn, instead of a rune.*



WHISPERED LORE ×2 · Take any card from the Faerie Magik discard pile into your hand. *Play during your turn.*



BOUNTIFUL HARVEST ×2 · Gain 3 additional steps this turn. *Play during your turn.*



BLIGHT ×2 · The completing player does not place a Wisp. All other completion steps still occur. *Play at anyone's completed dance.*



SCRYING POOL ×2 · Look at your own Radiance card, or at a rival's Court card. *Play anytime.*



WISP-LURE ×2 · Move 1 Wisp from one Court to another. *Play anytime.*



SNUFF OUT ×2 · Remove 1 Wisp from any Court. *Play anytime.*



WISP-CALL ×2 · Place 1 Wisp in any Court. *Play anytime.*

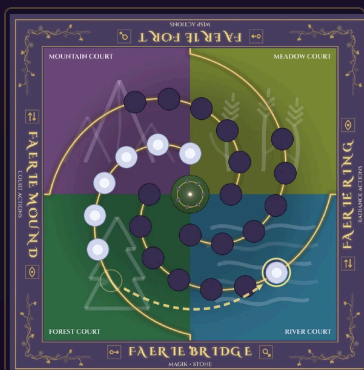


COLD IRON ×4 · Cancel the Magik card just played, including another Cold Iron. In that case the first card resolves after all. Removed from the game once used. *Play in response to any Faerie Magik.*

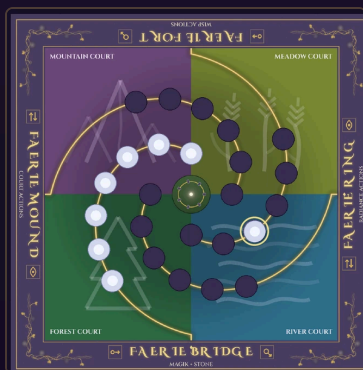
◆ MIDSUMMER DANCE

Play as the base game, with these changes:

- The Faerie Bridge is in play: a fourth dance of 7 stones, Conjured side up. Any stone can be flipped between plain and Conjured, and a Conjured Stone can move to a different dance.
- Completing a dance no longer grants a Magik card; the Faerie Bridge is the only source of gaining new Faerie Magik cards.



Moved. A Conjured Stone leaves the Bridge for the Ring's outer end: the Bridge shrinks, the Ring grows, and riders travel along.



Flipped. A stone turns to its other side; any Glamour on it returns to its owner's reserve.

RUNE POWERS

- 1 · Mandatory Flip: turn any stone to its other side. Glamours on it return to their reserves. Then move 1 step.
- 2 · Mandatory Move: place any Conjured Stone at the outer end of any dance, its own included. Glamours on it travel with it. Then move 2 steps. Waived if none is on the board.
- 3 · Move 3, or redraw your own Court: discard face up, draw, look, keep hidden. *A declared card discarded this way goes to the discard face up.*
- 4 · Move 4, or redraw your own Radiance: discard it face up, and place the new card facing away, unseen.
- 5 · Move 5, or force a rival to redraw. You choose the rival, and Court or Radiance.
- 6 · Move 6, or move 1 Wisp from one Court to another.

WHEN THE TRACK CHANGES

Stones define the track: removing one shortens that dance by a space; adding one lengthens the destination. Other Glamours stay on their stones; an empty dance cannot be entered. A move can leave a Glamour on an innermost stone; that dance completes at once (see FAQ).

FAQ

COLD IRON CANCELED MY COLD IRON. WHAT HAPPENS?

The original card resolves. Both Cold Irons are removed from the game.

CAN BLIGHT BE PLAYED DURING A CALL?

No. Blight is playable only at a dance's completion (W2). It cannot stop the Prince's declared Wisp.

MY CALL WAS CANCELED. DO I STILL GET THE FAVOR?

No. The Call replaced the favor, and it is spent either way.

I MADE A CALL, AND FAERIE MAGIK TRIGGERED ANOTHER CALL.

Finish the current Call first. If it fails, resolve pending Calls in the order they were triggered. If it succeeds, the game ends and pending Calls are ignored.

NO PLAYER BELONGS TO THE CALLED COURT. WHO WINS?

If a player chooses to Call for an empty Court, the High Fae admit no Fae to their council. The game ends. If a 7th Wisp is placed in a Court and nobody claims to belong to it, the Wisps are brought down to 4 and the game continues.

THE PRINCE'S DECLARED WISP WAS THE 7TH.

The Call is forced there at once, before he does anything else, and rivals may still answer in the window.

A STONE MOVED AND MY GLAMOUR IS NOW ON AN INNERMOST STONE DURING A RIVAL'S TURN.

Your dance completes immediately. You resolve the full completion sequence (p. 4), including a Call if you choose one. If several dances complete at once, resolve them clockwise from the active player.

A DECK RAN OUT.

Court and Radiance decks: shuffle the discard into a new deck (face-up Court cards shuffle in face down; their patrons return to hiding). Faerie Magik deck: never reshuffled; if empty, no card is drawn.

WHEN CAN I PLAY "ANYTIME" CARDS ON A RIVAL'S TURN?

Only during a reaction window. See below.

REACTION WINDOWS

When a window opens, the active player announces the event and pauses. In clockwise order from the active player's left, each player plays one eligible card or passes; continue until all players pass consecutively. A closed window cannot be reopened.

W1 · Any Magik card is played → Cold Iron may cancel it.

W2 · A dance is completed, before its Wisp is placed → Blight.

W3 · A Wisp is placed in or moved into a Court, including the Prince's declared Wisp; any Call there, chosen or forced by the 7th Wisp, is announced at that same moment → Scrying Pool, Wisp-Lure, Snuff Out, Wisp-Call. Never Blight. The Call is checked only after the window closes.

A LONGER DANCE

Experienced or large groups may raise the Call threshold before setup: choose 6 to 10; players may Call at that many Wisps, and 2 more force the Call.